Spring Seller Checklist

A FALL-TO-SPRING TIMELINE FOR GEORGIAN BAY HOMES · MIDLAND · PENETANGUISHENE · TINY · TAY · WASAGA BEACH

Oct–Nov · Before the freeze

- [ ] Fall exterior + drone photos while the colour is up
- [ ] Book a pre-listing home inspection
- [ ] Septic pumped and inspected; keep the written report
- [ ] Any tank parging done while it's still above about 10°C
- [ ] Tiny: check septic re-inspection area / open notices
- [ ] Well water bacteria test (SMDHU bottles, Midland)
- [ ] Tighten loose deck handrails and steps
- [ ] Open the attic: check for rodents and wildlife
- [ ] Service furnace + A/C; keep the records
- [ ] Clean gutters; winterize outdoor taps
- [ ] WETT inspection for any wood or pellet stove
- [ ] Start any shoreline/dock approvals

Dec–Jan · Inside work

- [ ] Work through the inspection list
- [ ] Prime + paint old water stains (keep the invoice)
- [ ] Declutter room by room; pre-pack
- [ ] Small repairs: taps, doors, caulking, bulbs
- [ ] Test smoke + CO alarms (every storey)
- [ ] Vacant? Check insurance vacancy clauses
- [ ] Optional: start a long-term radon test
- [ ] Start the house book

Feb–Mar · Paperwork + pricing

- [ ] Find your survey; ask about an updated SRPR
- [ ] Septic record search (Tiny) / ESA record search
- [ ] Oil tank: age, location, records
- [ ] Private road / snowplowing agreements
- [ ] List anything you know about for disclosure
- [ ] Three written quotes for anything you can't fix
- [ ] Review pricing (fresh CMA) with Jonathan
- [ ] Book photographer, cleaners, stager, trades

Final 2–4 weeks

- [ ] Spring walk-around: roof, gutters, grading, sump
- [ ] Re-test the well after the melt
- [ ] Cottage: re-open water, check lines + pressure tank
- [ ] Deep clean top to bottom
- [ ] Depersonalize + stage main rooms
- [ ] Clear walkways of snow, ice and slush
- [ ] Interior photos (pair with fall exteriors)
- [ ] House book on the kitchen counter

Three-quotes rule: If something needs replacing and you can't do it before you list, get three written quotes. When a buyer says "that's $20K to fix," you can answer with real numbers.

Jonathan Wallace, Realtor with Faris Team Real Estate Brokerage · jonathan@faristeam.ca · jonathanwallace.ca/home-value.html · General information only; confirm municipal rules with your Township.

Your House Book

THE RECORDS BUYERS WANT TO SEE · LEAVE IT ON THE KITCHEN COUNTER FOR SHOWINGS

Service records

- ☐ Furnace / boiler service
- ☐ A/C or heat pump service
- ☐ Septic pump-out + inspection report
- ☐ Well water test results
- ☐ Chimney sweep / WETT certificate
- ☐ Pest control invoices (if any)

What's been updated (with year)

- ☐ Roof _____
- ☐ Windows / doors _____
- ☐ Furnace _____ A/C _____
- ☐ Water heater _____
- ☐ Electrical panel _____
- ☐ Plumbing _____
- ☐ Well pump / pressure tank _____
- ☐ Septic tank / bed _____

Receipts + paperwork

- ☐ Repair and renovation invoices
- ☐ Building permits + final inspections
- ☐ Warranties (roof, windows, appliances)
- ☐ Appliance manuals
- ☐ Survey / SRPR
- ☐ Shoreline / dock permits
- ☐ Oil tank records
- ☐ Road / snowplowing agreements
- ☐ Utility + heating costs, last 12 months
- ☐ Three quotes for anything not fixed

Nice touches

- ☐ Tabbed binder, newest records first
- ☐ One-page summary of updates at the front
- ☐ Optional: QR code to a shared Google Drive folder

Why it works: every question the house book answers before a buyer asks is one less objection later. Buyers who have to guess usually assume the worst.

Want to know what your home is worth before you start? Book a home evaluation at jonathanwallace.ca/home-value.html or email jonathan@faristeam.ca.

Jonathan Wallace, Realtor with Faris Team Real Estate Brokerage · Midland, Ontario · jonathanwallace.ca